CHOOSE THE MOST IMPORTANT QUALITY ATTRIBUTES AND DECIDE ON THE METRIC

When you, with the data product owner, establish a list of possible quality attributes, try to limit them to only those that are crucial. Keep the list short and simple. A too-big list of quality attributes leads you to a data product that is optimized for everything and nothing at the same time.

When we have a list of important quality attributes, prepare a straw man's proposal of metrics or measures of success for these nonfunctional requirements.

DEFINITION Making a *straw man's proposal* is a technique to propose a solution that is obviously wrong. Because it is wrong, it will usually trigger the recipient to provide a better proposal.

As you can see in table 9.3, the values in the "Straw man's proposal" column will trigger discussions with the data product Owner and Business Stakeholders. The result of these discussions should be collected in the form of two measures of success: worst possible but still acceptable, and optimal. This way, you will know your boundaries as a designer.

Table 9.3 Quality attributes, measures of success, and straw man's proposals

Qualityattribute	Measure of success	Straw man's proposal	Worst acceptable	Optimal
Auditability	Persistency	One week	One year	Five years
Privacy	Access to personal data	Everyone in Messflix has access.	The production team has access.	Only HR people in the production team have access.

For auditability, the straw man's proposal that you show to stakeholders is to keep the cost statements for one week. Because you plan to use cost